

China Brokers Sector

Sector catchup on multiple tailwinds

Equities

China

Financial Services

Rally on likely strong Q226 results and policy tailwinds

China brokerages (H) surged 6.1% on 22 June, against a 0.65% decline in the Hang Seng Index, flipping the sector into YTD outperformance of ~7pp ([Figure 1](#)). The rally, in our view, was driven by two catalysts. First, listed brokers are on track for strong Q2 results, underpinned by robust market activity Q2-to-date (see para 2). Second, policy tailwinds are building, including but not limited to last week's Lujiazui Forum (see para 3) and the *Action Plan for Stabilizing and Optimizing Foreign Investment Attraction* ('[the Plan](#)') issued jointly by MOFCOM, NDRC and MOF. The Plan extends derivative market access to foreign institutions, including treasury futures; and grants them fund advisory licenses, moves that could accelerate the industry's pivot toward a buy-side advisory model. Multiple policy tailwinds have emerged YTD. In May, CSRC rolled out the first [departmental rules](#) governing derivatives ([UBS note](#)), building toward long-term upside. In April, the regulator unveiled a new round of [ChiNext reforms](#) ([UBS note](#)), introducing a fourth set of listing criteria.

Listed brokers are on track for strong Q2 results

CN brokers are poised for a strong Q2 ([listed brokers recorded 39% YoY growth in Q1 recurring NPAT](#)), with broad-based gains across major business lines. Market momentum has held firm into Q2. In Q2-to-date, A-share stock ADT jumped to Rmb2.8 trn, up 1.2x YoY (vs. Q1: +69% YoY) and 9% QoQ. Margin financing and securities lending balances rose to Rmb3.0 trn, up 62% YoY (vs. Q1: +36% YoY) and 14%QoQ. A-share IPO fundraising surged 65% YoY and 91% QoQ. Retail sentiment remained buoyant: new hybrid fund issuance reached Rmb96 bn, up 1.8x YoY, while new trading account openings hit 5.3mn in April-May, up 51% YoY. The CSI300 index rebounded 13.7% in Q2-to-date, reversing a 3.9% decline in Q1, a tailwind for brokers' investment portfolios. Leading brokers are well-placed to benefit from STAR market exposure, leveraging their integrated IB, research and investment capabilities via follow-on investment commitments and private equity holdings.

Lujiazui Forum recap: market stability, tech narrative, and further opening-up

Lujiazui Forum struck a market-stabilization tone. Moves to attract long-term capital and broaden financial instruments (incl. active ETFs) should strengthen market structure, underpin trading volume and asset allocation flows, and facilitate a slow-bull market. Brokers would benefit across wealth management, brokerage and institutional businesses. On equity financing, regulators signalled more inclusive listing standards at STAR and ChiNext markets, with a focus on AI (STAR 5th Listing Criterion) and deep-tech sectors. Expanded support for M&A, refinancing, and onshore listings of eligible HK-listed companies should boost deal flow and lift investment banking revenues. On cross-border, regulators are advancing RMB FX futures pilots and backing HK's launch of 5-year RMB treasury futures, while directing flows through Stock Connect, QDII, and Cross-border WM Connect.

Stock call: CICC (H), CITICS (A/H), HTSC (A/H) and GTHT (A)

We see a re-rating opportunity in the sector, underpinned by likely strong Q2 results and easing selling pressure. Despite the recent rally, YTD China brokerages (H) and (A) were down 0.4% and 6.8% respectively, against the Hang Seng Index down 7.3% with the CSI300 index up 9.3%. We expect medium- to long-term tailwinds to remain intact, with leading brokers set to benefit disproportionately from stronger regulatory support, broader non-brokerage franchises, higher pricing power and accelerating industry consolidation. Our covered brokers are trading at an average of 1.2x/0.8x 2026E PB, which we view as undemanding given the improving earnings outlook and structural growth drivers. We prefer CICC (H), CITICS (A/H), HTSC (A/H) and GTHT (A).

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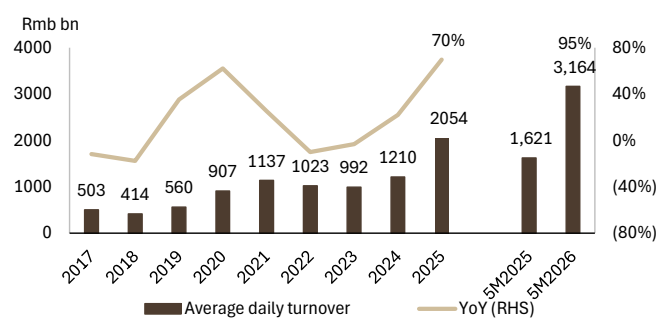
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Figure 1: Broker sector stock performance

Ticker	Name	Date	Price	2026-06-22	WTD	MTD	QTD	YTD	FY25
HSI.HI	HSI	2026-06-22	23,768.52	-0.7%	-0.7%	-5.6%	-4.1%	-7.3%	27.8%
887640.WI	CN Broker Index	2026-06-22	1,429.22	6.1%	6.1%	11.5%	18.6%	-0.4%	36.7%
6030.HK	CITICS	2026-06-22	28.36	6.1%	6.1%	8.9%	21.4%	5.4%	31.5%
3908.HK	CICC	2026-06-22	21.72	7.8%	7.8%	10.7%	26.5%	11.0%	54.2%
6886.HK	HTSC	2026-06-22	17.73	4.7%	4.7%	11.9%	19.7%	-5.8%	48.4%
2611.HK	GTHT	2026-06-22	15.45	5.2%	5.2%	18.3%	18.9%	-4.4%	54.6%
6881.HK	CGS	2026-06-22	7.98	5.3%	5.3%	2.8%	1.0%	-20.4%	46.7%
6178.HK	EBS	2026-06-22	8.02	3.6%	3.6%	7.5%	5.8%	-9.8%	13.9%
6066.HK	CSC	2026-06-22	12.86	8.6%	8.6%	13.3%	24.1%	0.2%	35.1%
6099.HK	CMS	2026-06-22	17.41	4.3%	4.3%	18.9%	32.7%	24.9%	-9.6%
3958.HK	Orient	2026-06-22	6.10	6.6%	6.6%	7.2%	13.0%	-10.8%	40.8%
1776.HK	GFS	2026-06-22	18.60	9.7%	9.7%	15.2%	29.2%	5.6%	74.7%
6806.HK	SWHY	2026-06-22	2.69	5.5%	5.5%	3.9%	-0.7%	-11.5%	35.6%
000300.SH	CSI 300	2026-06-22	5,059.66	2.4%	2.4%	3.4%	13.7%	9.3%	17.7%
886054.WI	Broker Index	2026-06-22	10,597.72	7.5%	7.5%	9.4%	9.8%	-6.8%	4.1%
600030.SH	CITICS	2026-06-22	28.64	7.8%	7.8%	11.7%	21.1%	2.4%	-0.7%
601995.SH	CICC	2026-06-22	35.44	6.1%	6.1%	4.9%	9.4%	1.3%	4.4%
601688.SH	HTSC	2026-06-22	21.29	8.9%	8.9%	17.1%	19.6%	-9.7%	37.4%
601211.SH	GTHT	2026-06-22	18.15	5.0%	5.0%	18.0%	9.4%	-11.7%	12.6%
601881.SH	CGS	2026-06-22	13.04	7.9%	7.9%	6.2%	2.4%	-17.0%	5.2%
601788.SH	EBS	2026-06-22	15.05	6.1%	6.1%	5.5%	-1.2%	-14.2%	-1.9%
601066.SH	CSC	2026-06-22	27.39	10.0%	10.0%	12.3%	27.7%	2.9%	4.6%
600999.SH	CMS	2026-06-22	19.65	5.8%	5.8%	15.7%	27.3%	18.1%	-10.6%
600958.SH	Orient	2026-06-22	9.76	6.0%	6.0%	4.8%	8.0%	-10.5%	5.4%
000776.SZ	GFS	2026-06-22	22.70	10.0%	10.0%	20.2%	26.4%	3.1%	39.6%
000166.SZ	SWHY	2026-06-22	4.63	5.0%	5.0%	5.0%	-1.1%	-12.1%	0.0%
601377.SH	Industrial	2026-06-22	6.24	7.2%	7.2%	8.5%	6.3%	-15.9%	21.1%
002736.SZ	Guosen	2026-06-22	10.37	5.3%	5.3%	6.1%	-4.2%	-17.5%	20.9%
601555.SH	Soocohow	2026-06-22	8.06	6.3%	6.3%	2.8%	2.8%	-11.0%	21.3%
600109.SH	Sinolink	2026-06-22	8.99	6.5%	6.5%	3.7%	7.3%	-3.3%	7.9%
000783.SZ	Changliang	2026-06-22	8.60	10.0%	10.0%	10.1%	30.4%	9.8%	22.2%

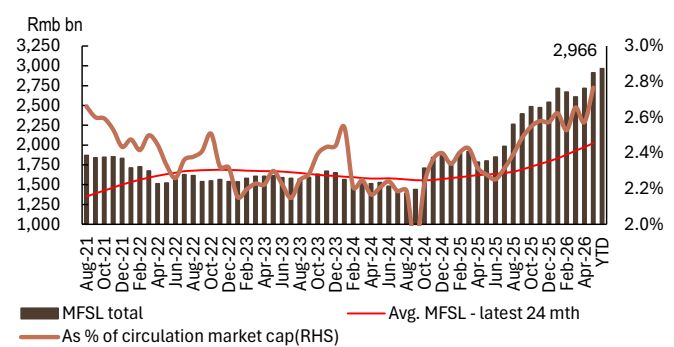
Source: Wind, UBS

Figure 2: A-share equity-linked ADT rose 95% YoY to Rmb3.2 trn in 5M26



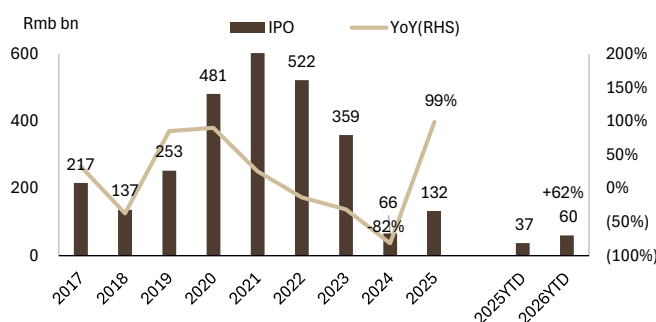
Source: Wind, UBS estimates

Figure 3: Margin financing and securities lending balances rose to Rmb3.0 trn, up 62%/14% YoY/QoQ



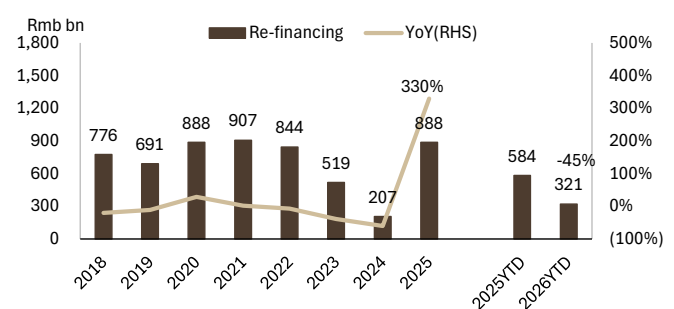
Source: Wind, UBS estimates

Figure 4: YTD A share IPO underwriting value +62% YoY



Source: Wind, UBS estimates

Figure 5: YTD A share refinancing underwriting value down 45% YoY



Source: Wind, UBS estimates. Note: the 2025 comparable base was boosted by private placement fund-raising of several state-owned banks.

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

We believe main risks to China's securities sector include: 1) a market downturn and greater access to licenses, leading to increased industry competition; 2) risk of sustained commission decreases; 3) the scale of margin financing, share pledges and other capital intermediary services is lower than expected and thus contributes less to earnings than expected; 4) regulatory penalties; 5) innovation-related failures that could lead to reputational loss, the loss of customers, lawsuits or other risks; and 6) lower-than-expected earnings or other risks due to fluctuations in investment income.

CITIC-A/H: Our price target is based on P/BV-ROE methodology for CITIC-A and DDM for CITIC-H. We think the main upside risks for the stock include: 1) higher-than-expected activity in the A-share market; 2) decreasing regulatory risk; and 3) faster-than-expected business development driving earnings to overshoot estimates. The main downside risks include: 1) brokers experiencing lower earnings and de-rating amid a protracted A-share slump; 2) slower-than-expected progress in innovative segments; and 3) large-scale employee turnover leading to sharp declines in market share and earnings.

Huatai-A/H: Our price target is based on P/BV-ROE for Huatai-A and DDM for Huatai-H. We believe key downside risks facing the company include: the opening-up of off-site account opening, internet applications and increasing lite outlets (engaged in trading and margin financing only) could intensify brokerage competition, causing commission rates to decline in the medium-to-long-term; if debt financing increases and interest expenses rise, margin financing, share pledges and other capital intermediary services may make less-than-expected earnings contribution; failure in innovation may lead to reputational damage, customer losses, litigation, regulatory penalties, etc; volatile securities market investment return, persistently sluggish trading, etc.

CICC-H: Our price target is based on DDM for CICC-H. We think the main downside risks include: 1) brokers experiencing lower earnings and downward re-ratings amid a protracted A-share slump; 2) slower-than-expected progress in innovative segments; and 3) fiercer competition in the brokerage business and declining commission rates in the medium to long term.

GTHT-A: Our price target is based on a P/BV-ROE methodology. Downside risks include: 1) disappointing outcomes from the merger; 2) weaker-than-expected profit contributions from capital intermediary services such as margin financing and equity pledge loans amid higher debt financing and interest expenses; 3) continued volatility in investment returns, subdued market trading activity; and 4) the risk of Haitong International remaining loss-making in its investment operations.

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Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 31 March 2026.

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Company Disclosures

Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
CITIC Securities - A ^{16,7,18,6a}	600030.SS	Buy	Rmb28.64	22 Jun 2026
CITIC Securities - H ^{16,7,18,6a}	6030.HK	Buy	HK\$28.36	22 Jun 2026
China International Capital - H ^{28,7,18}	3908.HK	Buy	HK\$21.72	22 Jun 2026
Guotai Haitong Securities - A ^{4,28,7,18,6a,6b,6c}	601211.SS	Buy	Rmb18.15	22 Jun 2026
Huatai Securities - A ^{2,13,4,5,28,7,18,6a,6c}	601688.SS	Buy	Rmb21.29	22 Jun 2026
Huatai Securities - H ^{2,13,4,5,28,7,18,6a,6c}	6886.HK	Buy	HK\$17.73	22 Jun 2026

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